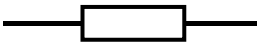
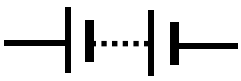
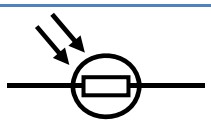
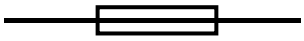
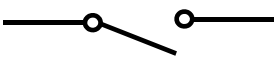
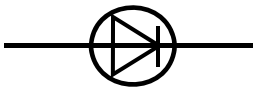
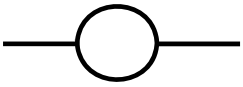
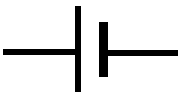
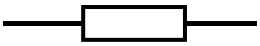
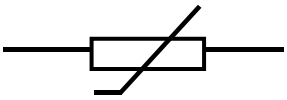
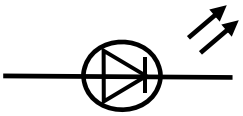
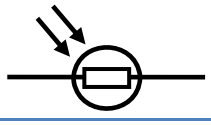
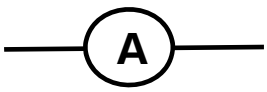
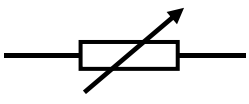
Task

Complete the table.

Component	Symbol	Function
		Lights up when current flows through it
open switch		
diode		
		Measures potential difference across a component in volts
cell		
		
thermistor		
led		
closed switch		
		
		
ammeter		
		A component which can have its resistance changed to vary the amount of current flowing through a circuit.

Answers

Component	Symbol	Function
lamp		Lights up when current flows through it
fuse		Breaks a circuit if too much current flows through it by the metal wire melting
open switch		Creates a break in the circuit so that current cannot flow
diode		Allows current to flow through it in one direction only
voltmeter		Measures potential difference across a component in volts
cell		Source of potential difference in a circuit
resistor		Has a designed resistance to electric current passing through it
thermistor		A resistor which reduces in resistance when heated
LED		Diode that emits light when a voltage is applied
closed switch		Completes a circuit so that electric current can flow
battery		Two or more cells electrically connected to provide a source of potential difference
LDR		A resistor whose resistance varies depending on the light intensity
ammeter		Measures electric current through a circuit in amperes
variable resistor		A component which can have its resistance changed to vary the amount of current flowing through a circuit

Teaching notes

Ask students to complete the table. To differentiate, remove rows or add in more information.

As an alternative activity, the answer sheet could be cut up and used as matching cards.